

2-6: Reduce the following Boolean expressions to the required number of literals.

(a) $ABC + A'B'C + A'BC + ABC' + A'BC'$ to five literals

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= (ABC + A'B'C) + A'BC + (ABC' + A'BC') \quad (\text{Theorem 4(a)}) \\
 &= ((CAB + CAB') + A'BC) + (C'AB + C'AB') \quad (\text{Postulate 3(a)}) \\
 &= ((C \cdot (AB + A'B') + A'BC) + (C'(AB + A'B'))) \quad (\text{Postulate 4(a)}) \\
 &= (C'(AB + A'B')) + (C \cdot (AB + A'B') + A'BC) \quad (\text{Postulate 3(a)}) \\
 &= (C'(AB + A'B')) + C \cdot (AB + A'B') + A'BC \quad (\text{Theorem 4(a)}) \\
 &= ((AB + A'B')C + (AB + A'B') \cdot C') + A'BC \quad (\text{Postulate 3(b)}) \\
 &= ((AB + A'B')C + (AB + A'B') \cdot C) + A'BC \quad (\text{Postulate 4(a)}) \\
 &= (AB + A'B')(C + C) + A'BC \quad (\text{Postulate 3(a)}) \\
 &= (AB + A'B') \cdot 1 + A'BC \quad (\text{Postulate 5(a)}) \\
 &= (AB + A'B') + A'BC \quad (\text{Postulate 2(b)}) = (A'B' + AB) + A'BC \quad (\text{Postulate 3(a)}) \\
 &= A'B' + (AB + A'BC) \quad (\text{Theorem 4(a)}) = A'B' + (BA + BAC') \quad (\text{Postulate 3(b)}) \\
 &= A'B' + (B \cdot (A + AC)) \quad (\text{Postulate 4(a)}) = A'B' + (B \cdot ((A + A') \cdot (A + C))) \quad (\text{Postulate 4(b)}) \\
 &= A'B' + (B \cdot (1 \cdot (A + C))) \quad (\text{Postulate 5(a)}) = A'B' + B \cdot ((A + C) \cdot 1) \quad (\text{Postulate 3(b)}) \\
 &= A'B' + B \cdot (A + C) \quad (\text{Postulate 2(b)})
 \end{aligned}$$

(b) $BC + AC' + AB + BCD$ to four literals

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= BCD + (BC + AC' + AB) \quad (\text{Postulate 3(a)}) \\
 &= (BCD + BC) + (AC' + AB) \quad (\text{Theorem 4(a)}) \\
 &= (BCD + BC \cdot 1) + (AC' + AB) \quad (\text{Postulate 2(b)}) \\
 &= (BC \cdot (D + 1)) + (AC' + AB) \quad (\text{Postulate 4(a)}) \\
 &= (BC \cdot 1) + (AC' + AB) \quad (\text{Theorem 2(a)}) \\
 &= BC + (AC' + AB) \quad (\text{Postulate 2(b)}) \\
 &= BC + (AB + AC') \quad (\text{Postulate 3(a)}) \\
 &= (BC + AB) + AC' \quad (\text{Theorem 4(a)}) \\
 &= (BC + BA) + AC' \quad (\text{Postulate 3(b)}) \\
 &= B \cdot (C + A) + AC' \quad (\text{Postulate 4(a)})
 \end{aligned}$$